A-A-51856A
1 March 1988
SUPERSEDING
A-A-51856(DM)
26 February 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SPONGE, SURGICAL, (NONWOVEN SYNTHETIC FIBER, SPEAR-SHAPED)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers a spear-shaped surgical sponge.

Salient Characteristics:

The sponge shall comprised of a handle (proximal end) and a triangularly shaped point (distal end).

The sponge shall be suitable for use in surgical ophthalmologic procedures and the sponges shall be sterile when tested in accordance with the U.S.P. The sponges shall be spear-shaped.

The points shall be a lint free, non-shredding, dry, cellulose nonwoven fiber material. The points shall be capable of absorbing a minimum of eighteen times their weight in fluids. The nonwoven fiber material shall be 0.065 ± 0.010 inch thick when measured in accordance with method 5030 of Federal Test Method Standard No. 191. The points shall have the shape of an isosceles triangle. The points shall be 11/16 ± 1/16 inch long (length of its long altitude) and their base shall be 11/32 ± 1/32 inch wide. The points shall be free from ragged edges and their distal end shall be sharp.

The handles shall be non-rigid for ease of movement with the fingers, shall be polypropylene and shall be a solid rod having a diameter of 0.093 ± 0.005 inch and a length of 2-1/8 ± 3/32 inches measured from the base of the points. The handles shall not overlap or extend into the points by more than 5/32 inch.

AMSC/NA FSC 6510

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One handle shall be firmly fastened at the center of the base of each point. The longitudional axis of the handles and the long altitude axis of the points shall be the same axis. The overall length of the sponge shall be a nominal 2-13/16 inches.

Workmanship. The Surgical Sponges shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). Six Surgical sponges shall be placed in a glassine envelop. Each glassine envelop shall be packaged in a sealed peel-open type envelop capable of maintaining sterility unless package is damaged or opened. One package containing 24 sealed envelops (144 surgical sponges), as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item. Testing and examination shall be conducted to determine compliance with all specification requirements. Test methods shall be suitable, accurate and reproducible.

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Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The unit of product for examination shall be one surgical sponge. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for examination shall be conducted at inspection level II, AQL 2.5 maximum percent defective.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric Products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6510-01-125-3241	SPONGE, SURGICAL, NONWOVEN SYNTHETIC FIBER, Spear-Shaped, 0.625 by 0.313 inch, 144s

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC 44410

Project No. 6510-0740

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